

Story invitation

Cue -> story invitation -> room

Core move

Invite the story behind a real cue, then give enough silence for the person to choose depth.

Minimum viable phrase

"What is the story behind that?" Use it only after a cue and with a warm tone.

Calibration

Continue when they add sequence, detail, or thoughtful pause. Release when they go brief or guarded.

Recovery

"No need to go into it. I was trying to understand context, not pry."